



IELTS Listening Practice Test

Transcript — Parts 1–4 · Episode 2

PART 1

You will hear a telephone conversation between a customer, Arthur, and a booking agent, Beatrice, discussing a guided kayak tour. You now have some time to look at questions 1 to 10.

Speaker B: Welcome to River Adventures. My name is Beatrice. How can I help you today?

Speaker A: Hello Beatrice. My name is Arthur, and I'd like to book a guided kayak tour for next month, please.

Speaker B: Certainly, Arthur. Let me pull up our booking form. Can I get your last name first, please?

Speaker A: Yes, it's Pendelton. That's spelled P-E-N-D-E-L-T-O-N.

Speaker B: Great, thank you. We have several scenic routes available. Which one were you interested in booking?

Speaker A: I saw the Gorge Route on your website and that looks absolutely perfect for us.

Speaker B: Excellent choice. The Gorge Route is incredibly beautiful this time of year. What date would you like to book that for?

Speaker A: We are looking at the 18th of July. Is there any availability on that day?

Speaker B: Yes, we actually have a morning slot open on July 18th. Let me note that date down. And could I have a contact phone number for you?

Speaker A: Yes, it's 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-4-2.

Speaker B: Let me just repeat that back to make sure I got it right... 0-7-7-0-0-9-0-0-1-4-2. Is that correct?

Speaker A: Yes, that's exactly it.

Speaker B: Now, what is the previous experience level of the kayakers in your group?

Speaker A: Well, we are all at the beginner level. None of us have done much kayaking before.



Speaker B: That's absolutely fine. The Gorge Route is very calm, and our guides will give a full safety briefing. How many participants will there be in your group?

Speaker A: There will be three of us in total. My two friends and myself.

Speaker B: Perfect, three people. Do you need to rent any equipment, or do you have your own?

Speaker A: We have our own life jackets, but we will definitely need to rent helmets.

Speaker B: No problem, we can provide those on the day. The meeting point for the Gorge Route is outside the pavilion near the main car park.

Speaker A: Did you say the pavilion?

Speaker B: Yes, that's right. The wooden building next to the lake entrance. The total price for three people, including helmet rentals, comes to 135 pounds.

Speaker A: Okay, that sounds very reasonable. How should I pay the deposit?

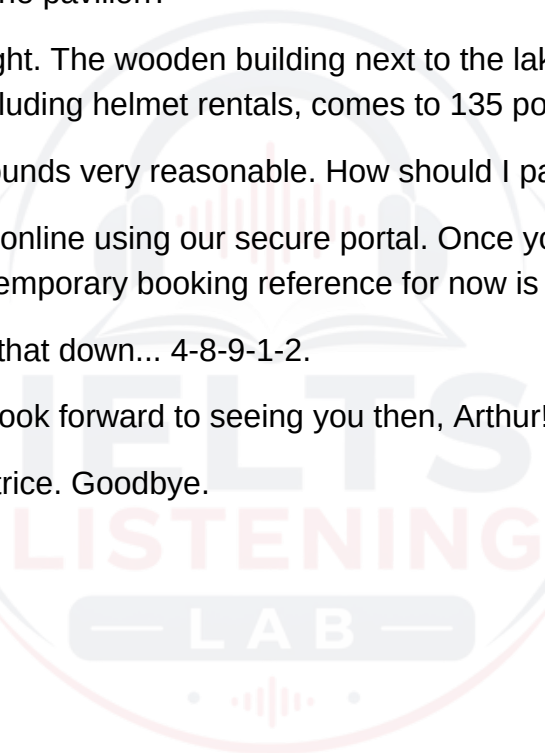
Speaker B: You can pay online using our secure portal. Once you do, you'll receive a confirmation code. Your temporary booking reference for now is 4-8-9-1-2.

Speaker A: Let me write that down... 4-8-9-1-2.

Speaker B: Exactly. We look forward to seeing you then, Arthur!

Speaker A: Thanks, Beatrice. Goodbye.

This is the end of Part 1.



PART 2

You will hear a talk by Clara, the coordinator of a community greenhouse program, introducing the initiative to local residents. You now have some time to look at questions 11 to 20.

Speaker A: Good evening, everyone. My name is Clara, and I am the coordinator of the Greenfield Community Greenhouse. It's wonderful to see so many familiar and new faces here tonight. I'd like to share a bit about our journey, what we do, and how you can get involved. We originally took over a derelict plot of land behind the old railway station back in 2018. While our primary goal at the time was to reclaim and save this abandoned urban site from developers, we quickly realized it could serve a much greater purpose. Today, it has blossomed into a thriving community greenhouse. Funding was one of our first big hurdles. While we regularly receive generous donations from local businesses, and applied for a municipal council grant which unfortunately fell through, our main source of funding that allowed us to construct the greenhouse itself came from a national green charity. This grant secured our infrastructure and allowed us to purchase professional-grade materials. Since opening, we have offered a wide range of educational workshops. Our organic composting workshop is always highly informative, and we recently introduced one on propagation techniques which has sold out. However, our workshop on herb cultivation has seen the highest overall attendance this season, showing just how keen people are to grow their own seasoning at home. For those who want to hands-on experience, we highly recommend our volunteer program. We've had to make a few adjustments to our volunteer guidelines this year. While we used to have a very casual system where people wandered in, we now require everyone to sign in at the entrance for safety and insurance reasons. We still don't enforce a minimum hourly commitment, and while protective footwear is recommended, it isn't mandatory yet. Many residents also support us by visiting our weekend market. Every Saturday morning, we hold a small market on-site. We aren't permitted to sell our vegetables yet due to local regulations, but visitors love browsing our selection of rare flower bulbs, which we cultivate specifically for the public. We also hope to sell handcrafted wooden pots in the future once our carpentry workshop is set up. Now, if you are looking to join our volunteer team, there are a few key guidelines you need to follow. First, all new volunteers must complete a safety training session on their first Saturday morning. This is held at 9:00 AM and is essential before you handle any machinery or tools. We also ask that you help us maintain high hygiene standards; therefore, everyone should bring their own gloves to use during gardening tasks, as we cannot provide enough pairs for everyone. Don't worry about footwear, though; if you don't have suitable shoes, you can borrow a pair of boots from our main tool shed, provided you return them at the end of the day. To help us coordinate our projects, we are encouraged to write in the volunteer journal kept on the front desk to log your daily activities. This helps the next team know exactly what has been watered,



weeded, or planted. Lastly, to show our appreciation for your hard work, anyone who works a full shift will receive a free lunch prepared by our kitchen staff. We hope to see you there!

This is the end of Part 2.



PART 3

You will hear a discussion between two university students, David and Fiona, and their tutor, Edward, about their upcoming group research project on urban green spaces. You now have some time to look at questions 21 to 30.

Speaker A: Thanks for meeting with us, Edward. Fiona and I wanted to get your feedback on our progress for the urban green spaces research project.

Speaker B: No problem, David. It's a great topic. How are you progressing with your site selection?

Speaker C: Well, Edward, we've decided to change our focus. While the city center park is easier to get to, I think the suburban park is a better choice because of the recent ecological changes it went through after the construction of the new bypass.

Speaker A: That's true, and even though the city center park has more diverse plant species, the ecological impact of the bypass is a much more compelling research angle.

Speaker B: I agree, that's a solid rationale. What about your research methods?

Speaker A: My main worry is the survey we drafted. I'm afraid it might be too time-consuming to analyze all the open-ended responses. We only have three weeks before the final submission.

Speaker C: We could change the open-ended questions to multiple choice. That would solve the analysis time issue.

Speaker B: Yes, I'd strongly recommend that. It will save you a lot of headache. Now, what about your historical data?

Speaker B: As for historical data, many students head to the university's main library first, but they often find the records there are quite outdated. I'd highly recommend looking at the city council's online archives instead. They've recently digitized all their planning and environmental reports from the last fifty years.

Speaker C: What about the local historical society?

Speaker B: Their records are fascinating, but they are mostly focused on social history rather than environmental data.

Speaker C: Good to know. I also looked into drone photography for mapping the vegetation cover, but the university's research committee takes at least six weeks to approve a flight permit, which is far too long for our timeline.

Speaker B: Yes, unfortunately, the administration for drone flights can be quite slow. You'll have to rely on satellite imagery instead. Have you thought about how you'll present your findings?

Speaker A: For the final presentation, I was thinking of creating a physical 3D model of the park.

Speaker B: That's creative, David, but it's hard for a large audience in a lecture hall to see. What about interactive digital maps?

Speaker C: Yes! We can easily project those onto the screen, and it will look much more professional than printing poster boards.

Speaker A: Alright, let's go with interactive digital maps.

Speaker B: Excellent. Now, let's divide up the remaining tasks. Who is going to interview the local residents at the park?

Speaker C: I'll handle that. I live nearby, so it's easy for me to spend a weekend talking to visitors.

Speaker A: Great, and I'll take charge of analyzing the soil samples we collect. I enjoy lab work.

Speaker B: Excellent. What about drafting the project introduction?

Speaker C: I think we should do that together to ensure our research objectives are aligned from the start.

Speaker A: I agree, let's write the introduction as a joint effort.

Speaker B: And the data charts for the results section?

Speaker A: I'm quite proficient with spreadsheet software, so I can generate all the charts and graphs.

Speaker C: That works. And once the whole report is written, I can do the final proofreading. I have a keen eye for typos.

Speaker B: Sounds like a solid plan, team.

This is the end of Part 3.

PART 4

You will hear a lecture by a marine biologist named George about the history and evolution of deep-sea exploration technology. You now have some time to look at questions 31 to 40.

Speaker A: Good morning, everyone. Today we'll be exploring the fascinating history of deep-sea exploration technology, examining how humans transitioned from shallow divers to deep-sea explorers. The earliest diving bells were simple, dome-shaped chambers lowered into the water. To supply air to the occupants, these early designs relied on a primitive hose connected to a pump on the surface vessel. Though limited in depth, they allowed humans to stay underwater for hours. By 1930, engineers William Beebe and Otis Barton built the bathysphere. This steel sphere had windows made of fused quartz, which was incredibly strong and allowed them to observe deep-sea life down to over nine hundred meters. In the mid-20th century, Swiss physicist Auguste Piccard developed the bathyscaphe, a self-powered deep-submergence vehicle. His vessel, the Trieste, utilized a large float tank filled with gasoline. Because gasoline is lighter than water and incompressible, it was perfect for controlling buoyancy at extreme depths. In 1960, the Trieste made history by successfully descending to the bottom of the Mariana Trench, the deepest known point on Earth. Soon after, the famous submersible Alvin was built. Alvin was powered by innovative lead-acid batteries, which allowed it to maneuver independently, famously assisting in the discovery of hydrothermal vents. Today, we rely heavily on robotics to explore the abyss without risking human lives. Remotely Operated Vehicles, or ROVs, are tethered to surface research vessels by a thick steel cable which transmits power and high-definition video data back to the surface. These ROVs are highly versatile, equipped with cameras and robotic arms that can carefully collect samples of sediment and fragile deep-sea organisms. On the other hand, Autonomous Underwater Vehicles, or AUVs, operate without any direct pilot. They run entirely on pre-programmed instructions, navigating the depths independently for days at a time. The primary application of AUVs is to create highly detailed maps of the ocean floor using advanced sonar technology. Looking ahead, the greatest obstacle for future deep-sea technology is not the cold or the darkness, but rather the extreme water pressure, which increases by one atmosphere for every ten meters of depth, presenting an ongoing challenge for material scientists.

This is the end of Part 4.